Metropolitan Learning Center K-8

Changes beginning in 2027-28

WHAT'S HAPPENING?

- Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC) would change from a K-12 to a K-8 alternative (choice) school.
- High school (9th-12th) students would transition to another PPS alternative school, attend a focus option, or return to their designated neighborhood high schools.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Enrollment decline: MLC high school enrollment has fallen to a level that risks providing the level of programming students deserve.
- Changing MLC to K-8 matches district grade structures.

WHAT ELSE WAS CONSIDERED?

- Increasing enrollment, timing of student moves, and where students may transition to were all considerations.

WHAT WOULD STUDENTS GAIN?

- High schoolers will have a range of other options, from small and focused alternative learning communities to attending their neighborhood comprehensive high school with full high school athletics, advanced placement (AP) courses, and electives.

SCHOOL BUILDING CAPACITY & ENROLLMENT

	Functional Capacity	Utilization %	Historical Peak Enrollment	Current Enrollment (2026-2027)
Current School	487	50.3%	490 (1997-98)	281

Projected enrollment

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Status Quo/No Change	245	231	215	198	199
Recommendation	210	193	176	160	161

ENROLLMENT AND TRANSFER

- Neighborhood students: 8th-11th grade students will have a choice of PPS high schools.

WHO WOULD THE SCHOOL SERVE?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
Status Quo/No Change	21.1%	30.9%	1.1%	12.7%	Not Title 1
Recommendation	19.1%	29.8%	1.3%	12.8%	Not Title 1

ACADEMIC PROGRAM TRANSITIONS

- Academic Programs: MLC will serve grades K-8 only. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be blends required at both the elementary and middle school levels.
- Special Education: Currently, MLC has two Learning Center classes. With rightsizing, MLC will have 1.5 Learning Center classes serving K-8th grade.
- Student and Family Supports: William Temple House is identified as Metropolitan Learning Center's school-based mental health partner. Student Services is reviewing continuity of services for students who may transition to other schools, including high school students whose receiving schools have not yet been confirmed.

School transition supports: Teams from Central Office have developed a framework for implementing Rightsizing. This includes a menu of transition supports for all impacted school communities. This work is informed by lessons learned by districts across the country that have had successful school consolidations. The implementation framework includes guidance on merging academic programs and school-based teams, (such as Instructional Leadership, Climate, PTAs and others) tools, resources, and timelines. The framework includes timelines for merging school communities and onboarding staff, families and students to their new campuses. It also includes staffing timelines and plans for packing and moving furniture and instructional resources. This comprehensive framework will be shared with the community in December. If the Board of Education votes to proceed with Rightsizing for fall 2027, Central Office teams will begin working with school communities in January to implement transition supports appropriate to each community.